Aciclovir

FORM Oral suspension 200mg in 5ml

INDICATION

1. Suppression of neonatal Herpes Simplex virus
2. Post Exposure Prophylaxis (PEP) of Varicella Zoster as per most recent UKHSA guidance

DOSE RANGE

Indication 1: Suppression of neonatal Herpes Simplex virus

AGE	DOSE	FREQUENCY	ROUTE
Birth to 6 months	300mg/m^2/dose*	3 times daily	oral

*Use the modified body surface area (BSA) table to calculate doses. This table will give an approximation of the dose required. If a more accurate calculation of BSA is required please contact pharmacy

Modified BSA table

Body weight (kg)	Body Surface area (m^2)	Aciclovir dose (mg)
1	0.10	30
1.5	0.13	39
2	0.16	48
2.5	0.19	57
3	0.21	63
3.5	0.24	72
4	0.26	78
4.5	0.28	84
5	0.30	90
5.5	0.32	96
6	0.34	102
6.5	0.36	108
7	0.38	114
7.5	0.40	120
8	0.42	126

Round dose to nearest measurable dose for ease of administration
Duration of treatment as per appropriate specialist e.g. Dermatology/Infectious Diseases

Indication 2: Post Exposure prophylaxis (PEP) of Varicella Zoster

Criteria	DOSE	FREQUENCY	ROUTE
Neonate	20mg/kg Following at least 48 hours of IV aciclovir	4 times daily Duration of treatment will be deter as per most recent UKHSA guidance	oral

- **Duration of treatment will be determined by treatment group as per most recent UKHSA guideline – please see information on website**

FURTHER INFORMATION

- The use of the oral route in neonates is based on anecdotal evidence and the pharmacokinetics are uncertain.
- Diarrhoea has also been a particular problem.
- For post exposure prophylaxis (PEP), oral aciclovir is the recommended treatment. Where oral is contra-indicated due to renal toxicity or malabsorption see intravenous immunoglobulin (IVIG)(Post Exposure Prophylaxis) monograph (note IM VZIG no longer available)
- For further dosing in PEP for children >1month, see BNF-C and most recent UKHSA guidance

STORAGE Store at room temperature

LICENSED STATUS Unlicensed Use

APPLICABLE POLICIES West of Scotland Neonatal Guidelines

UK Health Security Agency Guidelines on post exposure prophylaxis (PEP) for varicella or shingles (accessible via www.gov.uk)

Consult local policy if applicable

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Dose may vary depending on indication, age, renal function, hepatic function, and concomitant medications.
This monograph should be used in conjunction with the terms of reference document prepared by the West of Scotland Pharmacist Group. Information is correct at the time of publication and as per local practice agreement.
For further advice contact your clinical pharmacist or pharmacy department.